

THE BUSINESS ARCHITECT

Weekly observations on services, chains and operating models

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CENTRAL OBSERVATION

The new European capabilities change service chains before they change technology. Their value depends on clear responsibilities, usable fallback and operating models that still work across borders and during disruption.

WEEKLY SELECTION · FOUR DEVELOPMENTS FROM A WIDER SCAN OF POLICY, LAW, THREATS, STANDARDS AND TECHNOLOGY

FIRST RESPONSE CROSSES ORGANISATIONAL BORDERS [1]

- FACT** The Commission proposed a secure EU communication system for first responders. It must work across borders and when terrestrial networks are unavailable.
- IMPACT** Emergency work can gain one communication path across agencies and countries, including degraded network conditions.
- TENSION** A seamless user experience can conceal unclear command, escalation and service ownership.
- DECISION** Model the cross border incident journey, decision rights and manual fallback before adopting the capability.

PAYMENT EXPERIMENTS TOUCH PUBLIC SERVICES [3]

- FACT** The ECB opened a new digital euro innovation round. Experiments will use APIs and a test environment from January to June 2027; issuance is not decided.
- IMPACT** The ECB invites transport, utilities, smart cities and inclusion scenarios as well as new payment interactions.
- TENSION** Fast experiments may outpace consent, complaints, reconciliation and operational support.
- DECISION** Define target journeys and failure journeys; keep experimentation outside production accountability.

CYBER RISK ENTERS EVERYDAY WORK [4]

- FACT** A Commission survey found three in four EU employees encountered suspicious digital contact. Phishing led at 39%; AI generated scams reached 15%.
- IMPACT** Suspicious messages are now routine operating conditions, not exceptional security events.
- TENSION** More controls can reduce exposure but also increase friction and workarounds.
- DECISION** Redesign high risk tasks around verification, escalation and recoverable human error.

SCALE UP NEEDS AN ADOPTION OPERATING MODEL [2]

- FACT** A Commission study for the 2028 to 2034 funding cycle finds strong European science and regulation, but weak scale up and industrial adoption.
- IMPACT** The study links European weakness to commercialisation and deployment, not only research quality.
- TENSION** Local optimisation and slow procurement can block scale even when funding exists.
- DECISION** Review how pilots become reusable services, with owner, demand signal, adoption path and retirement rule.

SECTOR IMPACT

-  **PUBLIC SECTOR** **DIRECT**
Response and payment journeys cross agencies. Define ownership, escalation and citizen fallback.
-  **FINANCIAL SERVICES** **DIRECT**
New payment journeys affect disputes and support. Test exception handling and accountability.
-  **HEALTHCARE** **DIRECT**
Care continues during outages only if roles are explicit. Exercise clinical communication fallback.
-  **ENERGY** **DIRECT**
Utility payments and incidents cross operators. Map handoffs, degraded service and restoration.
-  **LOGISTICS** **DIRECT**
Border operations need common procedures. Test language, authority and chain escalation.
-  **INDUSTRY + MFG.** **CONDITIONAL**
Scale up needs repeatable adoption. Decide how pilots become supported operational services.
-  **SERVICES** **DIRECT**
Phishing exploits routine work. Redesign approval and customer contact verification.

DECISION AGENDA

ACT NOW Service owners: map the critical journey, fallback step and accountable role for each shared dependency.	ASSESS Run failure scenarios across organisations; record gaps in handoff, support and citizen or customer remedy.	WATCH Track which ECB scenarios progress beyond experimentation and when operating duties become...	TRIGGER Reopen the operating model when a shared capability changes accountability or removes a manual path.
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PRIMARY SOURCES · CLICKABLE LINKS

- [1] Commission · Critical communication · 30 Sep 2026
- [2] Commission · Strategic digital technology · 29 Sep 2026
- [3] ECB · Digital euro innovation call · 28 Sep 2026
- [4] Commission · Workplace cyber threats · 30 Sep 2026

Consistent in Design. Powered by Logic.

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